

Μάρκος Αὐρήλιος ὁ Στωϊκός

Marcus Aurelius the Stoic Philosopher Writing to Himself

eul_aid: qpy

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή φιλοσοφική [Philosophical Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Stoic](#)

Marcus Aurelius was a Roman emperor who ruled from 161 to 180 CE and a dedicated Stoic philosopher. He was born in 121 CE into a prominent family and was adopted by the emperor Antoninus Pius, who prepared him for leadership. His education included instruction from the Stoic teacher Junius Rusticus, who introduced him to the works of the philosopher Epictetus.

His reign was marked by near-constant military campaigns, internal challenges, and a major plague. He died in 180 CE, likely at a military camp along the Danube frontier. His lasting importance rests on a single surviving work, his personal writings known as the *Meditations*. This text is a collection of private reflections and philosophical exercises, written primarily during his military campaigns. It was not intended for publication, making it a unique and intimate record of his thoughts.

In the *Meditations*, he grapples with applying Stoic principles—like accepting fate, focusing on virtue, and serving the common good—to the immense pressures of ruling an empire. According to modern scholars, Marcus Aurelius is significant not as an original theorist but as the archetypal "philosopher-king." His work provides a powerful example of an individual striving to live a philosophical life amid extreme responsibility. As one of the last major figures of ancient Stoicism, the *Meditations* has served as a crucial text for transmitting Stoic ideas and continues to be widely read for personal ethical guidance.

Works (1)

- Τὰ εἰς ἑαυτόν · [To Himself](#) · 486 passages

Other Stoic Authors

- Ἀπολλόδωρος ὁ Σελευκεύς · [Apollodorus of Seleucia](#) · 1 work
- Ἀπολλοφάνης ὁ Στωϊκός · [Apollophanes the Stoic](#) · 1 work
- Ἀρχέδημος ὁ Ταρσεύς · [Archedemus of Tarsus](#) · 1 work
- Ἀρίστων ὁ Χῖος · [Ariston of Chios](#) · 1 work
- Ἄρειος Δίδυμος · [Arius Didymus of Alexandria](#) · 2 works
- Ἀρριανός ὁ Νικομηδεύς · [Arrian of Nicomedia](#) · 18 works
- Ἀθηνόδωρος Κορδυλίων · [Athenodorus of Tarsus Cordylion](#) · 1 work
- Χαιρήμων ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεύς · [Chaeremon of Alexandria](#) · 1 work

- Χρύσιππος ὁ Σολεὺς · Chrysippus of Soli · 6 works
- Χρύσιππος ὁ Σολεὺς · Chrysippus of Soli II · 1 work
- Κλεάνθης ὁ Ἄσσεύς · Cleanthes of Assos · 2 works
- Κορνοῦτος ὁ Στωϊκός · Cornutus the Stoic Philosopher · 1 work